

2.4.3 Hinduism

Religion, peace and justice

Attitudes to war	• Attitudes towards war • The concept of ahimsa • Ahimsa and Satyagraha as developed and used by M.K. Gandhi
Violence and pacifism	• Attitudes towards the use of violence • Attitudes towards pacifism and ahimsa • The traditional roles of the different varnas, particularly kshatriyas • Reasons for these attitudes
Crime and punishment	• Concept of justice • Aims of punishment • Attitudes towards capital punishment • Beliefs about the treatment of criminals • Responses to the treatment of criminals • Samsara, as applied to this issue
Social injustice	• Concept of social justice and injustice • Beliefs about social injustice • Responses to social injustice

Religion and equality

Principle of equality	• Attitudes towards varnashramadharma as they relate to caste and discrimination • Approaches towards caste and equality
Attitudes towards racism	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to race and the status of foreigners • Practices in relation to racism
Attitudes towards gender	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to gender • The role of women in Hindu society
Attitudes to religion	• Attitudes towards other religions to promote tolerance and equality



Forgiveness and reconciliation

- Beliefs about forgiveness
- Impact of beliefs about forgiveness on believers
- Beliefs about reconciliation
- Impact of beliefs about reconciliation on believers

Religion and the media

Relationship with the media

- The different forms of media
- The influence of the media
- Portrayal of Hinduism in the media
- Portrayal of important religious figures
- Responses and attitudes towards films which focus on religious/philosophical messages
- Responses and attitudes towards books and comics which focus on religious/philosophical messages

Use of the media

- Using the media to represent Hinduism
- To convert non-believers
- To educate both Hindus and non-Hindus

Censorship/freedom of speech

- Concept of censorship and freedom of speech
- Beliefs and attitudes towards the portrayal of violence and sex
- Attitudes and responses to issues raised by freedom of speech